Kofi and the Almost-Perfect Machine

A Copper Tree story to colour and create



A story to share. A world to make your own.

Created by Emotive Impact

You are part of the adventure.

Meet six friends who live in Copper Tree. They ask questions, make things, make mistakes and help each other. There is room for you too.

Amara
An artist with wonderfully big ideas.

Kofi
An inventor who loves figuring things out.

Zuri
An explorer with a question for everything.

Eli
A playful friend who loves a good game.

Nia
A gardener who notices the little things.

Tayo
A dreamer who keeps looking up.

Read together or on your own. After every two story pages, there is a picture to colour. Use the drawing spaces for your own ideas. You can tell someone your answer instead of writing it.

Grown-ups: print at actual size on A4 paper. Single-sided printing is helpful for colouring. Try pencils or crayons first. Place scrap paper underneath if using felt-tip pens.

A muddle of pencils

On rainy afternoons, six friends squeezed into the Lookout, their clubhouse in Copper Tree Garden. Today, Amara needed a green pencil. She found three red ones, a sock and a biscuit crumb. Kofi pushed his round glasses up his nose. “We need a pencil machine.” “Does it draw?” asked Eli. “Does it make biscuits?” asked Tayo. “It sorts,” said Kofi.

Your turn

Design a pencil pot for the Lookout. Add a picture that helps everyone recognise it.

The secret project

At Uncle Deji’s repair workshop, Kofi drew a ramp with three little doors. You chose a door, and your pencil slid into its pot. Uncle Deji helped prepare smooth cardboard pieces and watched Kofi fit them together. “Who will try it?” he asked. “Everyone. When it’s perfect.” Kofi covered his plan with his sleeve. He wanted their first look to be a wonderful one.

Your turn

Draw three different signs for the machine’s three doors. They can be shapes, colours or pictures.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 1



Almost

Kofi tried a short pencil. It slid into a pot. He tried a long pencil. It stuck sideways. He tried two pencils. They met in the middle and refused to move. “Traffic jam,” said Uncle Deji. Kofi moved a door and tried again. This time a pencil rolled onto his shoe. His machine was almost perfect. Unfortunately, almost was taking ages.

Your turn

Invent a funny name for this machine. Draw the name or a symbol on its sign.

Under the cloth

On Saturday, Kofi carried the machine to the Lookout with Uncle Deji. A cloth hid its three pots. His friends crowded round. “Can we see?” asked Zuri. “It needs one tiny change,” said Kofi. He bent over the ramp. A pot tipped. Pencils pattered across the table. Kofi pulled the cloth over everything. “Perhaps we should do something else.”

Your turn

Draw what a friend could say when somebody’s plan goes wrong.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 2



A small question

Eli stopped reaching for a pencil. “Do you want help picking them up?” Kofi nodded. Nobody called the machine silly. Nobody went away. Uncle Deji sat beside him. “Which part would you like us to look at?” Kofi rubbed the cloth between his fingers. Then he lifted one corner. “The pencils keep getting stuck. I thought you might laugh.”

Your turn

Draw a friendly face and one way you could help Kofi feel welcome.

One pencil at a time

“I’d like to try,” said Nia. Kofi passed her a pencil. She held it sideways above the ramp. “Which way does it go?” Kofi blinked. He had always pointed his pencils straight down. “That way,” he said. Amara drew an arrow. They tried again. The pencil slid neatly into a pot. Kofi let out a breath he had been holding.

Your turn

Draw a big arrow on your own invention. What would it help somebody do?

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 3



The stubborn pencil

A longer pencil still caught at the bend. Zuri watched from the side. “It needs more room.” Uncle Deji helped Kofi widen the turn. Eli held the empty pot steady. Tayo crouched until his eyes were level with the ramp. “Mission control is ready.” Kofi released the pencil. It slid round the bend. “Landing successful!” whispered Tayo much too loudly.

Your turn

Draw a path for a pencil to follow. Give it plenty of room around the bends.

A useful mistake

Then they tried a chunky crayon. It stopped at the entrance. Kofi frowned, but this time he left the cloth alone. “That opening is too narrow.” “Crayons could have their own tray,” said Eli. Nia tried reaching the farthest door. “And could this handle be closer?” Kofi fetched his notebook. Soon there were more ideas than blank spaces.

Your turn

Design a special resting place for chunky crayons. Make its opening easy to reach.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 4



Everybody has a go

They made the handles easier to reach and added a wide crayon tray. Amara decorated the pots with different shapes. Now nobody needed to remember which pot was which. Each friend tried the machine while Kofi watched. He wanted to reach in and help. Instead, he asked, “What happened?” Sometimes the answer was “It worked!” Sometimes it was “Look at this.”

Your turn

Draw three pots, each with a different shape on the front. Colour them any way you like.

The grand opening

On Sunday, Mrs Bennett visited the Lookout. Kofi stood beside his machine. His stomach felt full of jumping beans. “It sorts pencils,” he said. “You choose a door and send one down. The crayons go here.” Mrs Bennett tried a blue pencil. Plonk! It landed in the star pot. “Excellent,” she said. “Where do you put a muddy gardening glove?”

Your turn

Draw an invention that would help Mrs Bennett in the garden. It can be wonderfully silly.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 5



The most important part

“Definitely outside,” said Nia, and everyone laughed. Amara retrieved her green pencil from the pot she had chosen. Kofi watched her begin a picture. His machine had a crooked corner and a patch of tape showing. It also had six people’s ideas in it. “What’s it called?” asked Zuri. Kofi considered. “The Almost-Perfect Pencil Machine.” “Catchy,” said Eli. “Needs a bigger sign.”

Your turn

Create the machine’s celebration sign. Add a symbol for everyone who helped.

The next idea

They put Kofi’s first drawing on the Lookout’s discovery shelf. Beside it, he placed a fresh sheet. “I’ve got another idea,” he said. “It’s only a scribble.” Six heads leaned together. Tayo pointed at a round shape. “Biscuit maker?” “A place to keep everyone’s muddy boots,” said Kofi. Tayo sighed. “One day.” Kofi handed him a pencil. “What would you add?”

Your turn

Draw your own almost-perfect idea. Add one thing a friend might suggest.

COLOUR COPPER TREE / SCENE 6



A place for you

Draw yourself with the Copper Tree friends. Where would you meet? What would you bring to share?

What happens next?

Invent another adventure. Draw the first thing the friends discover. Give your adventure a name, or tell someone your story.